

Uploading Book PDFs to IngramSpark

via a Linux desktop (VNC) inside Google Cloud Shell

Full self-contained walkthrough for uploading the print files to IngramSpark from a phone whose normal file picker doesn't work. You run a real Linux desktop (XFCE) with Firefox inside Google Cloud Shell (free), streamed to your phone. The book files are pulled straight into that desktop from GitHub, so the phone is just a screen.

■ Cloud Shell wipes installed packages and the desktop between sessions, but files in your home folder (~) survive. If you come back later, re-run Part A steps 1–3; your saved token (Part B) still works.

Part A — Start the XFCE desktop + Firefox

1. On your phone open <https://shell.cloud.google.com>, sign in, wait for the black terminal.
2. Install the XFCE desktop and a real Firefox (paste as one block):

```
sudo apt-get update -y && sudo apt-get install -y xfce4 xfce4-goodies dbus-x11 tigervnc-standalone-server novnc
cd ~ && rm -rf firefox firefox.tar.xz
wget --content-disposition -O firefox.tar.xz "https://download.mozilla.org/?product=firefox-latest&os=linux64&
tar xf firefox.tar.xz
ls ~/firefox/firefox && echo "FIREFOX OK"
```

If Firefox won't launch later (missing libraries):

```
sudo apt-get install -y libgtk-3-0 libdbus-glib-1-2 libx11-xcb1
```

3. Start the GUI. The **exec startxfce4** line is critical — if the xstartup script exits, the VNC session tears down instantly:

```
mkdir -p ~/.vnc
printf '#!/bin/sh\nunset SESSION_MANAGER\nunset DBUS_SESSION_BUS_ADDRESS\n%s/firefox/firefox &\nexec startxfce4\n' ~/.vnc/xstartup
chmod +x ~/.vnc/xstartup
tigervncserver -kill :1 2>/dev/null
tigervncserver :1 -geometry 1280x800 -localhost no -SecurityTypes None --I-KNOW-THIS-IS-INSECURE
pkill websockify 2>/dev/null; sleep 1
websockify --web=/usr/share/novnc 8080 localhost:5901 >/tmp/novnc.log 2>&1 &
echo "started"
```

Portrait phone screen? swap **-geometry 1280x800** for **-geometry 800x1280**.

■ XFCE gives you a full desktop: a top panel, an **Applications** menu, and the **Thunar** file manager so you can open ~/Downloads and confirm the book files are there before uploading. **dbus-x11 is required** or XFCE half-breaks (no panel/menus). If the desktop comes up grey, wait ~15s for the panel to paint, or check **cat ~/.vnc/*.log**. Cloud Shell reinstalls XFCE each new session, but ~ files (incl. ~/.vnc/xstartup and ~/.github_token) persist.

4. Open the desktop: Cloud Shell toolbar (top-right) → **Web Preview** (monitor/eye icon, maybe under ■) → **Change port** → **8080** → **Change and Preview**. If you see a directory listing or 404, add **/vnc.html** to the URL. Tap **Connect** — XFCE desktop with Firefox already open.
5. Hard to navigate? noVNC tab on the **left edge** → gear → **Scaling Mode** → **Local Scaling** (fits the whole desktop). Fullscreen button is there too.

Part B — Get the book files into Cloud Shell

1. Make a GitHub token (classic)

Phone's normal browser, logged into GitHub: **Settings** → **Developer settings** → **Personal access tokens** → **Tokens (classic)** → **Generate new token (classic)** → tick the top-level **repo** box → Generate → copy it (ghp_...).

■ A valid classic token is ghp_ + 36 chars = **40 characters total**. A different length means the paste grabbed extra/missing characters — the usual cause of **HTTP 401 Bad credentials**. Never paste a token into a chat/log; revoke any that lands in one.

2. (Recommended) Save the token so you never re-paste it

Files in ~ survive between sessions. Save it once (never into a repo — GitHub auto-revokes committed tokens):

```
echo 'export GH_TOKEN=PASTE_YOUR_TOKEN_HERE' > ~/.github_token
chmod 600 ~/.github_token
```

Every future session, instead of pasting the token, run:

```
source ~/.github_token
TOKEN=$GH_TOKEN
```

3. Sanity-check the token before downloading

```
curl -sL -o /dev/null -w "HTTP %{http_code}\n" -H "Authorization: token $TOKEN" \
  "https://api.github.com/repos/knightdx91-alt/The-Saeren-Chronicles"
```

200 = good. **401** = bad/mistyped token (re-check length). **404** = no access (use a classic token with the repo scope).

4. Download the files (Book One, barcode-fixed, press-ready)

```
rm -f ~/Downloads/*
cd ~/Downloads
source ~/.github_token; TOKEN=$GH_TOKEN      # or: TOKEN=PASTE_YOUR_TOKEN_HERE
api="https://api.github.com/repos/knightdx91-alt/The-Saeren-Chronicles/contents"
get(){ curl -sL -H "Authorization: token $TOKEN" -H "Accept: application/vnd.github.raw" -o "$2" "$api/$1"; }

get "book/genesis/saeren-chronicles/delivery/cover/Saeren-Book-One-FULL-WRAP-r3-PDFX1a.pdf" cover.pdf
get "book/genesis/saeren-chronicles/delivery/production/Saeren-Chronicles-Book-One-6x9-interior-r14-PDFX1a.pdf" interior.pdf

echo "=== want real sizes + %PDF header, NOT ~112 bytes ==="
for f in cover.pdf interior.pdf; do printf "%-12s " "$f"; ls -lh "$f"|awk '{print $5}'|tr -d '\n'; printf " hd
```

■ **USE THE -PDFX1a COVER.** The plain -CMYK-noicc file previews **blank/white** on IngramSpark and phone viewers because it has no OutputIntent. PDF/X-1a (CMYK + OutputIntent) is what IngramSpark expects and previews correctly.

■ **THE 112-BYTE FILE:** if a file is ~112 bytes or its header prints {, the token is wrong and you downloaded a GitHub error. Run **cat ~/Downloads/cover.pdf** to read it, fix the token, re-run. A real cover shows **%PDF** and ≈ 3.9 MB.

Other books: change the two paths. Book Two → book/genesis/saeren-chronicles-book-2/, Book Three → book/genesis/saeren-chronicles-book-3/. Always use the **-PDFX1a** files.

Part C — Upload settings on IngramSpark

In the Cloud Shell Firefox go to **ingramspark.com**, log in, open your title, start the upload. When the picker opens, choose files from **Home** → **Downloads** (or browse there in Thunar first).

Cover: choose “**my cover already includes a barcode**” so IngramSpark does NOT overlay its own white barcode box on ours.

Interior: the 6×9 PDF/X-1a (294 pages, Book One).

ICC-profile warning if shown is **non-blocking** — proceed.

Cover size: 12.91 × 9.25 in, full-bleed, spine 0.661” (294pp cream), no white margins.

eBook is a separate format: its interior must be an **EPUB** (a PDF is rejected there).

■ If a preview ever shows blank, confirm you uploaded the **-PDFX1a** file, not -CMYK-noicc. Before approving for sale, order a printed proof and confirm the barcode scans.

Quick reference — Book One files

cover : delivery/cover/Saeren-Book-One-FULL-WRAP-r3-PDFX1a.pdf (CMYK + OutputIntent)
interior : delivery/production/Saeren-Chronicles-Book-One-6x9-interior-r14-PDFX1a.pdf

Barcode verified: EAN-13 = 9798240990434 (ISBN 979-8-2409-9043-4), single barcode, no price add-on.

When done: revoke any exposed GitHub token and overwrite ~/.github_token with a fresh one.